

Nine Ally Quinn Premise Contenders

Sold at full strength. No caveats. Follow the spark.

THE THREE QUESTIONS

- 1 Which one would you most want to play immediately?**
- 2 Which image or revelation stayed with you?**
- 3 Which premise would you be most likely to describe to somebody else tomorrow?**

Working hook labels only - not proposed canon titles.

The Missing Thirty-One Seconds

F01

A fish-market buyer is stabbed after the closing auction, and within hours Havenbay has already chosen its killer: nineteen-year-old courier Leo Tan, caught in a viral clip running with the bloody knife. But the twelve-second video is missing thirty-one crucial seconds. By synchronising four stallholders' original recordings, Ally can reconstruct the full minute, prove Leo ran towards the victim rather than away from the crime, and trace the deceptive edit to the market treasurer protecting a lethal protection racket. It is immediate, visual and frighteningly contemporary - a murder mystery about how quickly a cropped truth can destroy someone. Best of all, clearing Leo comes with a brutal price: expose the only stallholder brave enough to help and cost her livelihood, or protect her while Leo loses his future.

TRISH'S GUT REACTION

Sparked me ☐ Maybe ☐ Not for me ☐ Top contender ☐

One thing that stuck:

The Last Visitor

F02

When a beloved newspaper editor is murdered in the Havenbay Gazette archive, the building log supplies an irresistible suspect: union organiser Nora Esposito was the last recorded visitor, and she had argued with him that night. The log is genuine - but the story everyone builds from it is false. Ally must reconstruct the journey of a single clipping box through handwritten circulation slips, scan batches and shelf photographs, uncovering a secret settlement file that the editor handled after Nora left and a trail leading straight into the newspaper's executive offices. This is a classic locked-building mystery with a wonderfully tactile investigative spine: not 'who broke in?' but 'what happened inside after the innocent suspect walked out?' Clearing Nora before a decisive union election means exposing another woman whose confidentiality and financial security the murdered editor was trying to protect.

TRISH'S GUT REACTION

Sparked me ☐ Maybe ☐ Not for me ☐ Top contender ☐

One thing that stuck:

The Wrong Deck

F03

A volunteer engineer is murdered aboard a decommissioned ferry during a packed heritage open day, and a visitor photograph appears to catch restoration protester Amara Bell trespassing on the restricted machinery deck. The image is real. Amara really did cross a barrier. Yet when Ally rebuilds the ferry's vanished configuration from visitor photographs and old deck plans, the impossible geometry reveals that the picture was taken through an undocumented service opening accessible only to Trust staff. The investigation turns the ferry itself into the puzzle, exposing a hidden theft operation and a director who exploited Amara's genuine misconduct to conceal murder. It offers a spectacular, uniquely Havenbay setting and a deeply satisfying reconstruction - then forces the player to choose whether clearing Amara is worth destroying the accreditation of the volunteer photographer whose unauthorised safety work makes the truth provable.

TRISH'S GUT REACTION

Sparked me ☐ Maybe ☐ Not for me ☐ Top contender ☐

One thing that stuck:

The Moving Wall

N01

Twenty years ago, actor Maren Holt was murdered backstage in a waterfront customs shed converted into a theatre. Nobody was charged, but understudy Elise Ward became Havenbay's accepted culprit and has been shut out of the city's theatrical life ever since. Ally discovers that every surviving account rests on a stage layout that never truly existed: rehearsal photographs, cue marks and a retired stage manager's notebook show a rolling scenery wall changing position during the fatal interval, briefly opening a forgotten customs passage from the donor lounge. Reconstructing the stage scene by scene transforms an old theatrical scandal into a living murder mystery and points towards the celebrated director whose money still controls the institution. To restore Elise's name, however, the player may have to expose the frightened stage manager who falsified the crucial safety record - and destroy the life he rebuilt.

TRISH'S GUT REACTION

Sparked me ☐ Maybe ☐ Not for me ☐ Top contender ☐

One thing that stuck:

The Missing Fund

N04

In 1988, union treasurer Isaiah Cole was murdered in an apparent street robbery, and the union concluded that he had stolen from the benefit fund before his death. His daughter Rina has spent decades branded as a thief's child, denied both the death benefit and a place in the waterfront community's memory. Then retired workers open old drawers and produce their stamped contribution stubs. When Ally connects those scraps of paper to meeting minutes and annual totals, they prove every dollar reached the fund - and that the money disappeared later through fraudulent hardship payments authorised by the man who still controls members' benefits today. This is a rich, emotional Havenbay mystery in which ordinary workers' keepsakes become the archive powerful people assumed did not exist. Winning justice for Rina means identifying the pensioner who supplied the proof, allowing the corrupt trustee to strip away his own lifeline.

TRISH'S GUT REACTION

Sparked me ☐ Maybe ☐ Not for me ☐ Top contender ☐

One thing that stuck:

The Wrong Brake Pin

N07

A shipyard safety delegate died beneath a failed gantry hoist, and the official finding blamed operator Tom Brodie for bypassing the lockout. Tom lost his licence, his pension and his name. Years later, one serial number tears that certainty apart: the supposedly installed brake pin was actually returned unused to its supplier, while the component photographed after the death carries a different casting mark. Ally follows that single piece of machinery through purchase order, dispatch record, service card, incident photograph and disposal record, uncovering substituted parts and a killing disguised as industrial error. It is a forensic chain-of-custody mystery with enormous human stakes, grounded in the dangerous working history of Havenbay's docks. Correcting the record may require naming the retired inspector pressured into signing the false service card, sacrificing her standing so Tom can finally reclaim his.

TRISH'S GUT REACTION

Sparked me ☐ Maybe ☐ Not for me ☐ Top contender ☐

One thing that stuck:

What He Could See

S01

Malcolm Saye was acquitted after shooting Ben Sato in his chandlery's fog-dark loading room, convincing a court that Ben advanced with a knife and that he fired in self-defence. Ben's daughter Talia has never accepted the account - and the powerful trades guild has punished her for saying so. Using the trial transcript, weather observations, scene photographs and an electrician's invoice, Ally reconstructs the room's geometry and the delayed emergency-light circuit. The result is devastatingly simple: from where Saye said he stood, under the conditions he described, he could not have seen the knife. This is the purest possible Ally Quinn hook - a player physically rebuilding what someone could know, not merely what they claimed. But making the contradiction public could destroy the electrician whose surviving records prove it, while silence costs Talia her last chance at the trade her father taught her to love.

TRISH'S GUT REACTION

Sparked me ☐ Maybe ☐ Not for me ☐ Top contender ☐

One thing that stuck:

The Rounded Minute

S03

Darius Webb remains in prison for a dawn fish-market murder because witnesses recognised his red waterproof and a payroll record placed him near the scene. But the coat was standard union issue - twenty workers owned one - and the decisive clock-out time was rounded. With a forgotten correction sheet, refrigerated-truck temperature printouts and fish-lot records, Ally can rebuild the morning minute by minute and show Darius unloading a truck when the murder occurred. It is an irresistibly clear miscarriage-of-justice mystery: one common coat, one distorted minute and years of a man's life. The player's work does not magically overrule the court; it creates the factual case his lawyer needs to reopen it. Forcing that review, however, means publishing a witness's revised account and exposing her to retaliation - or protecting her while Darius loses the opportunity and remains separated from his daughter.

TRISH'S GUT REACTION

Sparked me ☐ Maybe ☐ Not for me ☐ Top contender ☐

One thing that stuck:

The Shooter Who Was Already Gone

S07

A private-club accountant was murdered, a frightened bartender pleaded guilty as an accessory, and a wealthy patron who died before trial was named as the shooter. Case closed. Sentence served. Havenbay moved on - except Mateo Ruiz is still barred from the profession that defined him. Then a former payroll clerk produces her private notebook of off-book cash requests, and Ally begins connecting payments, staff rosters, receipts and sworn statements. The money reveals that employees were paid to repeat a false service timeline - and that the supposed dead killer could not have organised it. Behind him stands a very living security chief who murdered Celeste Mora, coerced Mateo into the cleanup and has spent years profiting from the club's silence. It is glamorous, sordid, morally tangled noir, with a killer who can be exposed even if prosecution remains uncertain. The price is the livelihood of the bookkeeper whose brave disclosure makes Mateo's correction possible.

TRISH'S GUT REACTION

Sparked me ☐ Maybe ☐ Not for me ☐ Top contender ☐

One thing that stuck: